Aabid Hussain Khan [a.k.a. Abu Omar] was one such activist. He was at the center of an 'online network that connected extremists in North America, Europe and South Asia.'[172] Using various online sobriquets, he indoctrinated recruits via secure internet forums after inveigling them from open discussion websites.[173] According to the US government, Khan was a 'facilitator' for Lashkar and Jaish-e-Mohammad, and the British security services believe he may have talent-spotted for one or both of them. During his trial in the United Kingdom, where he held citizenship, Khan testified to having connections with both groups.[174] He is also known to have visited Pakistan several times, and on one occasion went to the NWFP where he shot footage of himself with other 'American-sounding individuals in an area where LeT posters were prominently displayed on public walls.'[175] Khan was arrested as he flew back to Britain from Pakistan in 2006 and convicted two years later on counts relating to the possession of information useful for terrorism.[176] Among those with whom he was in contact were: two Americans from the state of Georgia, later convicted of providing material support to Lashkar; a Serbian militant in Bosnia-Herzegovina named Mirsad Bektasevic, later found in possession of over 20 pounds of plastic explosives, detonators, a suicide belt and a manifesto promising an attack on Western interests; and a number of Canadians who were part of what became known as the 'Toronto 18.'[177]

The two men from Georgia were Ehsanul Islam Sadequee and Syed Haris Ahmed, both of whom were in touch with Khan via various jihadi web fora on which they had become active by late 2004.[178] Sadequee and Ahmed, along with others in Khan's virtual network, determined they needed military training. Khan later admitted to making contact with Lashkar and JeM for this purpose. Sadequee thought Lashkar the better option, writing over email:

> I was thinking, we should be with LT, due to them being same 'Aqeedah [ideology or belief], and they fighting against Hindus, so the Murtaddeen [the Pakistani government] shouldn't bother us as opposed to if we go to other apostates-haters.[179]

In other words, Lashkar's special status vis-à-vis the state continued to make it a safe bet for foreign jihadis. Khan believed a covert staging point was needed since, as he wrote to others in the network, the group was growing and 'we cant have like 12 bearded people just go together to